

The Holy Spirit's Work in Us

Two Passages Explain the Same Ministry of the Spirit

In Romans 8:22, I want you to put a marker for an easy turn of the finger as we examine one verse that explains the meaning of another verse. We are going to cross-examine this from two chapters.

We will start in 2 Corinthians 5, where Paul was dealing with the Corinthians. They were really a Gentile church, not as affected by the law as the church in Rome, which had a strong population of Jews and was very affected by the law.

To the Corinthians, Paul explains it one way. To the Romans, he explains it another. It gets very interesting because both passages say the same thing. Together they supply enough of the mind of God to open a tremendous truth.

This has made a big difference in my life and explained everything.

Hang in close with me. This is one of those times when one meaning sets you up for the meaning of the next, and the next verse, and the next. This is not a time where I can lose you anywhere.

When we teach on praying in the Holy Ghost, what we are really teaching on is the ministry of the third Person of the Godhead on the inside of a believer.

Jesus said:

Ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me.

The Holy Spirit has actually come, the third Person of the Godhead, to represent Jesus in you. He brought a supernatural language with Him to pray for you with. It is absolutely unheard of that God Himself would take the knowledge He has and pray that knowledge for you.

No religion in the world has that. It draws the line of the supernatural. It is incredible.

What you are doing today, sitting around praying in tongues, is as supernatural as raising the dead because the origin of that language does not originate with you. God is actively working inside you to express that language. It is not you. The origin is not you.

What you are doing this afternoon is very important to your future and the fulfilling of your ministry in the mind of God.

The First Casualty of Spiritual Collapse Is Often Prayer

If you notice when people fall apart and leave, one of the first casualties is their prayer life. The devil is like any general. He knows that to defeat the enemy without losing his own troops, if possible, he cuts off the supply line. He cuts off the source.

We found out in our basics that there are four diversities of tongues. That is why He called that gift "divers tongues" in two places: the eighth of the nine gifts of the Spirit and the eighth operation of the eight operations of God.

He called it diverse tongues because it means diversities of tongues.

The Church is awfully confused about tongues. Any time you hear a mouth stand up and say, "You can pray too much," or "Tongues will make you weird," you know they know absolutely nothing about the supernatural languages of tongues.

The first diversity is tongues for personal edification.

The second is tongues in the public assembly for the sole purpose of interpretation.

The third is tongues that extends itself into the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit.

The fourth is tongues that presents itself as a sign to the unbeliever, transcending the intellect and empowering you to preach, testify, or witness in any language on the face of this earth that you had no previous knowledge of. That is a sign to the unbeliever personified.

What we are going to differentiate today is tongues for personal edification, which is what you are basically doing this afternoon, and tongues that finally extends itself into the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit.

Deep Intercessional Groanings Release a Different Measure of Power

You might as well know this: when you make that third diversity of tongues, the deep intercessional groanings, you are operating in a mega amount of power. The Holy Ghost is kicking in as much power as it takes to move the mountain that is in your way.

That is equivalent to the mighty workings of miracles or any of those operations, because when He is able to kick into your life with that, I can promise you things are going to move.

Some churches have claimed to make intercession because they come up and start groaning, stop groaning, start groaning, stop groaning, almost at a set signal. Then they wonder why nothing ever happens in their church.

I can tell you why.

The deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit are not like tongues. Tongues is for your own edification. The groanings of the Spirit are as He wills. I cannot start them. All I can do is wait for them to come and yield to them. I cannot start them any more than I can stop them, that is, if I

want to flow with God.

At times, in my own emotions, I have been so grieved and so emotionally wrought and moved by somebody, usually somebody I really love, that I have gotten into an emotional groaning. But that is not the same thing as the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit.

One is from me. It is compassion from my own heart. The other is enacted by the power of the Holy Spirit.

Generally, unless a person is well acquainted with the Holy Spirit's edification, he does not make it very far into the things of the Spirit. I imagine there have been rare exceptions, when God brought someone along who had no teachers and never knew what did it, but his heart was sold out.

But there is also a path ordained as the walk of the Spirit that any believer can take, and it will end up with the same results. God will use you, and I am talking about deliberately.

Learning to Pray Beyond Distractions Is Part of the Walk

Someone says, "I can hardly pray in an atmosphere like this, with commotion and kids running around."

I would still rather have the children here watching me pray. I like to blueprint that into them.

You have to learn to pray when some people are not praying. What if they hung you up by your toenails and tortured you with hot irons? Would you quit praying because it disturbed you? Much less because a person wandered by? Give me a break.

One thing that is good for warding off people who come up to talk to you is the evil eye. I am only kidding.

I know sometimes I need to talk to you. If I depended on today for my prayer time, you would have no food. However, if you gave up this day on your schedule, if I were you, I would spend it with Him.

When you come by and I talk to you a few minutes, I really do not mind, because usually you earnestly want something answered in the Spirit, and that is in divine order with God. But when I see you fellowshiping a lot with people who do not know any more than you do, I suspect I can see what is happening.

"Are you having a good time?"

"Oh, yes, I am."

Are you ready to follow me closely? Let us begin.

Keep in remembrance that Romans 8 is saying exactly the same thing as 2 Corinthians 5. As soon as we read this, we will flip over and see it.

The Earthly Tabernacle Groans for the Heavenly Body

Second Corinthians 5:1 says:

For we know that if our earthly house of this tabernacle were dissolved, we have a building of God, an house not made with hands, eternal in the heavens.

Then Paul says:

For in this we groan, earnestly desiring to be clothed upon with our house which is from heaven.

That house from heaven is your glorified body.

He continues:

If so be that being clothed we shall not be found naked.
For we that are in this tabernacle do groan, being burdened...

We do not just want to die. We are not groaning to be unclothed, but to be clothed upon, that mortality might be swallowed up by life.

Then he says:

Now he that hath wrought us for the selfsame thing is God, who also hath given unto us the earnest of the Spirit.

If you are going to underline anything, underline "groan" and "wrought."

He that has wrought us, or worked this work in us, for the selfsame thing is God. What selfsame thing? The things we just read. He has saved us for all these things and has also given unto us the earnest of the Spirit.

Not only did He save us for these things, but He gave us the earnest of the Spirit. That is how I know I am going to make it.

Romans 8 Shows Creation and Believers Groaning for Redemption

Now let us go to Romans 8 and see the comparison.

Romans 8:22 says:

For we know that the whole creation groaneth and travaileth in pain together until now.

The whole creation, every created thing, groans and travails like a pregnant woman in pain. What is all creation groaning for? To be delivered from the bondage of corruption it was placed in.

All of creation, right down to the last atom, came under the curse. All of it is groaning, pregnant with a new heaven and a new earth, travailing like a pregnant woman to give birth to this.

Earlier in the chapter, Paul called it vanity. Creation was subjected to vanity, corruption, and imperfection. Everything imperfect is in a form of intercession, like a pregnant woman. Creation wants to be free too.

But in verse 23, he switches the emphasis from creation to you and me:

And not only they, but ourselves also, which have the firstfruits of the Spirit, even we ourselves groan within ourselves...

Is this not starting to sound like 2 Corinthians 5?

We groan within ourselves for what? Paul says:

...waiting for the adoption, to wit, the redemption of our body.

"To wit" is old King James English meaning to be made complete or brought to culmination.

Those of us who have the firstfruits of the Spirit groan within ourselves, waiting for the adoption process to be made complete at the redemption of our bodies.

What are the firstfruits? Being born again and given the earnest of the Spirit. Born again and filled with the Holy Ghost. Those are the firstfruits.

All creation is waiting for this: the manifestation of the sons of God. And we who have the firstfruits of the Spirit groan within ourselves, waiting for the adoption process to be completed when our bodies are redeemed.

In other words, we are waiting to be clothed with that glorified body, that house from the heavens not made with hands.

Hope Waits for the Glorified Body, but the Earnest Works Now

Second Corinthians 5 says, "He that hath wrought us for the selfsame thing is God." Romans 8 makes the same statement in verses 24 and 25:

For we are saved by hope: but hope that is seen is not hope: for what a man seeth, why doth he yet hope for?

But if we hope for that we see not, then do we with patience wait for it.

When Paul said God saved us in hope, what did He save us in hope of? Immediately in these verses, he is talking about the adoption process being made complete when we receive a glorified body.

The first thing I am saved in hope of is a glorified body.

In 2 Corinthians 5, Paul worded it this way: "He that hath wrought us for the selfsame thing is God." He that saved us in hope of that glorified body is God.

In 2 Corinthians 5, Paul includes the whole ministry of the Holy Spirit in your life in one simple statement: "He gave us the earnest of the Spirit."

In Romans 8, he says it in detail. He says we are saved in hope of a glorified body, and we wait for it with patience because we cannot make the rapture come any faster by believing for it. It will come at the time it is going to come.

It does not matter that you are imprisoned in a body capable of sin. You are still trapped here in hope of a glorified body.

But Paul says He gave us the earnest of the Spirit. In Romans 8, he goes into detail and says, "You do not have to wait alone. You have the earnest of the Spirit."

Where 2 Corinthians 5 gives the blanket statement, "He gave you the earnest of the Spirit," Romans 8 explains how the Holy Spirit works that earnest:

Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities...

You are imprisoned in this body by hope, waiting for a glorified one. Likewise, the Spirit helps your infirmities, your inability to produce results because of the limitations imposed on you by the flesh.

He helps that particular weakness.

You do not know how to pray as you ought. He steps in with groanings which cannot be uttered. He that searches the heart knows the whole plan of God and makes intercession for you according to the will of God.

Then we can know all things will begin to work together for good to them that love God and are called according to His purpose.

What Paul said in 2 Corinthians 5 in one blanket statement, Romans 8 explains in detail. When you can differentiate between the two, you are going to find out just how powerful your prayer life is.

The Earnest of the Spirit Is God's Guarantee Against the Purchased Possession

We can start by defining earnest.

Those of you in real estate know what earnest money is. You find a house you like and put earnest money down on it. That earnest money is a token of your sincerity in the purchase. It is money against the promised possession.

After you were born again, God searched around, found you, and said, "I am going to give you a little bit of heaven against the purchased possession. I am going to give you heaven to go to heaven with. When this purchase is finished, I want the promised possession to come home to be with Me."

So God put His earnest money down on you against the promised possession. At the end of this, He wants you.

The earnest of our inheritance has come to guarantee three things.

First, He is the earnest guarantee of God of the power to fulfill your ministry on this earth. He offers Himself in edification, that supernatural language of tongues, to pray the plan of God. That is what Paul was talking about when he said He that searches the heart knows the mind of God and makes intercession for you according to the will of God. Then we can know all things will work together.

He is your only true promise of power, direction, and leadership of the Spirit to fulfill your ministry. He is the only earnest that will see you through. There is no other path with that guarantee.

Second, He is the guarantee of your glorified body.

Third, He is the earnest and the power to finally deliver the purchased possession to God, to bring you home to heaven.

He came to fulfill your ministry, deliver you a glorified body, and bring you home to heaven.

God is His earnest to you. If you follow Him, God will never lose His earnest money against the promised possession. Never.

Personal Edification Begins the Work Immediately

When you begin to pray in the Holy Ghost, you begin to instigate the earnest of the Spirit.

You start with that basic little tongue called tongues for personal edification. That is why He comes simultaneous with your rebirth. At the same moment you are born again, it is His desire that you be under teaching so you are immediately filled with the Holy Ghost.

That is the first operation of God He will fulfill in you freely, no strings attached.

The eight operations of God are the mighty apostle, prophet, teacher, workings of miracles, gifts of healings, helps, governments, and finally the eighth operation, diversities of tongues.

I cannot fulfill the other seven instantly. But there is one operation that can begin to function simultaneous with my rebirth, and that is tongues for personal edification.

At that level of the operation of the earnest, He starts dealing with all our problems, no matter how bad they are, and begins your progressive walk. If you stay with Him, He will deliver you out of all of them.

The Spirit Sanctifies Flesh, Soul, and Wrong Believing

This sanctification process will be finished in three areas. Sanctification means to be separated from the world. Because of tongues, the Holy Ghost immediately begins a sanctification process that takes in your whole spirit, soul, and body.

He begins with the body first. He separates you from filthiness of flesh: drinking, smoking, chewing, and all those kinds of habitual things.

When we are born again and filled with the Holy Ghost, He gives us that language so God can get busy praying through us. When I say praying for us, I mean it is actually you doing the praying, but He is creating the prayer.

Paul says:

For if I pray in an unknown tongue, my spirit prayeth...

He creates the prayer. We actually do the praying, but it is under the power of the Holy Spirit.

You will not get five words out of your mouth in tongues for edification before He begins the sanctification process to deliver you from the filthiness of the flesh. You will not say five words before the Holy Ghost is already planning the execution of the positional death of your old man.

Edification Makes the Conscience Strong Enough to Hate Sin

Let me illustrate this.

Suppose a man gets born again, and he has a habit of cruising the red-light district. He gets born again, filled with the Holy Ghost, and goes to a nice church. That church teaches him promiscuous grace, so he does not bother to go any further with the flesh. He keeps visiting the red-light district.

Then one day a good friend brings him to a church where they preach real holiness and freedom from sin.

He comes into counseling and says, "I cruise the red-light district."

The pastor says, "Oh, my God." Then, being a wise pastor, he says, "You know those things are not good. How about starting to pray an hour or two a day in tongues?"

So the man begins to pray an hour or two a day in tongues, and the edification process begins. It builds him up until that new nature spills over into his soul. His conscience starts flooding into his soul, and he starts having trouble continuing with that sin.

Pretty soon he says, "Pastor, I have good news. I put one of them in the car, but I let her right back out. Something is really bothering me."

Sure it is. Because through edification, the sanctification process has begun.

Where intercession kicks in is when the Holy Ghost has so edified you and built you up that you hate the thing you are doing wrong as much as God hates it.

When you hate it as much as God does, God steps in and says, "Now you are finally giving Me something to work with."

Then He is able to come alongside and step in with the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit. When that takes place, a mega amount of power is released, and you actually become separated from your problem.

Groanings Which Cannot Be Uttered Are Not Manufactured by the Believer

Notice what Paul said:

Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities: for we know not what we should pray for as we ought: but the Spirit itself maketh intercession for us with groanings which cannot be uttered.

For years I translated that to mean I cannot fabricate this supernatural language of tongues. Since the Holy Ghost is doing it, it is not a natural thing I can do.

But then I thought, "Wait a minute. Praying in tongues is the same way." When I pray in tongues and become edified, it is not really me supplying the language. If He does not supply the language, I cannot do it. But because tongues is for my own edification, any time I want to pray, He supplies the language.

Now Paul is talking about the Spirit helping our weaknesses. We do not know how to pray as we ought, so the Spirit steps in and makes intercession for us with groanings which cannot be uttered.

Then it says that He who searches the heart knows the plan of God. He knows what kind of mountain is in your way.

At first, when we begin this walk in the flesh, the mountain in our way is usually things of the flesh. When He purges us there, He generally moves on to the soul, though sometimes flesh overlaps with soul.

Filthiness of soul is hatred, strife, envy, debates, unforgiveness, and those kinds of things against each other. Filthiness of flesh is basically where you destroy yourself. Filthiness of soul is where you move into a realm where you destroy other people. It is a more serious realm.

When He purges you from that, He will move on to filthiness of spirit.

Do not get excited. Filthiness of spirit simply means incorrect believing, wrong doctrine.

When you were born again, you received a nature the Holy Spirit could teach. You did not come into the Kingdom born of God all-knowing. You received a new nature capable of understanding spiritual things, which your carnal mind could not do.

People go to heaven and come back, and they have to ask a lot of questions in heaven because they did not go there knowing everything.

When you were born again, you received a nature that can be taught. Perfecting holiness means cleansing yourself from all filthiness of flesh and spirit. Filthiness of spirit is simply incorrect believing.

The Holy Ghost is equipped to sanctify you from wrong believing. How does He do it? When you pray long hours in tongues, you speak not unto men but unto God. In the Spirit you speak mysteries.

Those mysteries are the mysteries hidden in God since the foundation of the world, but now made available to the great Church of God: the mystery of everything Christ is in you, to you, and through you, the hope of glory, including God's plan for you.

You are not going to pray those mysteries, the understanding of everything Christ is in you, without Him straightening your doctrine out. When He answers that prayer, He straightens your doctrine and cleanses you from filthiness of spirit.

False Intercession Cannot Flow from Hatred

Right now, we are back on filthiness of flesh so we can understand the transition between simple tongues for edification and the deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit.

I did not understand what those groanings were. When Paul said they "cannot be uttered," I thought he meant I could not fabricate articulate speech of the Holy Spirit.

When He opened it up to me, I was shocked.

What helped me understand was a couple I had known for quite a while. God used their testimony to shoot revelation into my spirit and settle something in me.

I knew their lives. I knew what they were involved in and the level of flesh they were involved in. When they were here, they would go into the corner and groan and groan and groan, then indict us for just sitting there praying in tongues, as if we would never see anything.

When they wrote a letter, I tore it up. Revelation shot through me, and I said, "You are not making intercession."

We had dissected Romans 8:26, where Paul isolates an experience we have on a personal level, while 2 Corinthians 5 blankets His whole ministry in us under the earnest: to see to it that we stay saved, get a glorified body, fulfill our ministry, and go to heaven as a purchased possession.

I knew this couple had sued a sinner. The sinner had done something, and they said it damaged their lungs. They sued him.

Most of the time, if I decide to sue a sinner, I have just sold my testimony. I just do not have faith in God to move for me. If you do, that is between you and God, because there are all kinds of levels of walk. If you are really afraid about your needs and your body, then you have to do something.

Jesus said the man who breaks the least of His commandments and teaches men to do so is least in the Kingdom. He did not mean a teacher like me. He meant your lifestyle, everything about you. You come in there somewhere.

When God shot that revelation through me, I said, "Look, the same place in you that wanted to destroy that sinner is the same place intercession comes from. You are telling me out of one side of your face that you are going to destroy a sinner off the face of the earth, and out of the other side of your face that you are going to stand in the gap for the world as a mighty intercessor. Not on your best day."

Deep intercessional groanings and the capacity for compassion come from the same place. To make the groanings intercession, God has to have something from you, and it certainly cannot be hatred for the human race.

Deep intercessional groanings are the brother of compassion.

When I told them that, they never came back. They were going to take it upon themselves to instruct me, so I took it upon myself to instruct them. I was very nice about it. I am real nice to most of you. Sometimes I wait for God to talk to you. I would rather Him tell you than me.

The Eighth Operation Builds Us into Every Other Calling

I asked God, "What is the transition here?"

He gives tongues for personal edification to begin the process, to sanctify you from filthiness of flesh, move on to soul, and purge you from wrong believing if you stay with Him long enough.

In sanctification from filthiness of flesh, I am praying and praying. The gift He gave me for edification is building me up on my most holy faith.

Jude says:

These be they who separate themselves, sensual, having not the Spirit.

But ye, beloved, building up yourselves on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Ghost...

I keep praying, and I build myself up above that mess. If I am going to be built up above a mess, I have to leave something behind.

You may have the lust of the flesh attached to you big time, yet He has filled you with the Spirit. You can pray in tongues as well as anybody, but you keep having lapses into the flesh. Some of you may have anger or other things wrong. I have seen you land on people, I know.

But you can pray in tongues because you have that one diversity, the eighth operation of God, that you are qualified for. If you stay in that eighth operation, it will build you into the fulfilling of all the other seven, if you are called to them: helps and governments supernaturally, workings of miracles and gifts of healings, which include evangelists and pastors, the mighty teacher, and finally the mighty prophet.

It all starts with edification.

Can I prove it? Certainly. I could take you right now from 1 Corinthians 12 to 1 Corinthians 13.

Paul says:

Though I speak with the tongues of men and of angels, and have not charity, I am become as sounding brass, or a tinkling cymbal.

He started a progression there that begins with tongues, then moves to prophecy, then to understanding mysteries, then to mountain-moving faith, and finally to agape itself.

But we majored only on love and did not see the sequence of those levels that praying in tongues can deliver you to.

In 1 Corinthians 12, Paul went from the mighty apostle down to tongues. In 1 Corinthians 13, he reversed it and started with tongues, building up to mighty mountain-moving faith and the agape of the apostle. We just did not see the switch.

When You Hate the Weakness, the Spirit Has Something to Work With

Now I have this gift designed to build me up above the junk. I start praying, and my new creation conscience begins to spill into my soul. My conscience starts getting louder about what I am doing. I get uncomfortable with it. I cannot live with myself.

"My God, the more I pray in tongues, the more I hate myself. I thought praying in tongues was supposed to edify me. This is horrible. I do not want to go to that church anymore."

I know. You want a license to sin, and you do not want to be bothered about it.

The biggest favor you can do yourself is stay in it. If there is anyone I never want to leave me alone, it is God. "See me through, Earnest. Do not leave me alone. Pester me. Bug me. Finish Your possession and bring me home."

Eventually He will deliver you from that filthiness of flesh. When He starts delivering you from filthiness of soul, you begin the qualification process for compassion.

So I am praying, and now I hate myself. Every time I fall to that flesh thing, I cannot seem to be free. But one thing I will not stop doing is praying in tongues. I will not stop because the pastor said, "Whatever pit you crawled out of the next day, come back and turn your tongue loose. If it still works, turn it loose."

As long as your tongue works, you still have a chance. Even if your tongue will not work, all you have to do is muse in your heart for your tongue to start working, and it will start working.

As long as you can climb out of that pit and come back and put in three or four hours, you will end up hating that thing worse and worse until you say, "I do not know what is wrong with me. My heart hurts. I hate myself, and I do not know what to do. I have come to the end of myself."

An infirmity is an inability to produce results because of limitations imposed on you by the flesh. But now you have prayed yourself up to the front door. The good news is that whatever that flesh thing is, it is only between you and the next segment of God's plan.

Romans 8:27 states clearly that He who searches the heart knows the entire plan of God for you and makes intercession for you according to the will of God. Then all things begin to work together for good to them who love God and are called according to His purpose.

You occupy a little part in that overall plan, and the Holy Ghost knows what it is. That is what He is praying.

So now we have a mountain of flesh in the way of me and the perfect will of God. But that is okay. I have edified myself right up to it. The light of God has been shed. I hate myself because I have this pathetic weakness.

God looks and says, "Good. I have been waiting for this. Now you are finally giving Me something to work with. Before, when you loved it, what did I have to work with? But you edified yourself, and now you hate it. I have something to work with."

Then the Holy Ghost brings edification a step higher into intercession. He comes alongside, takes hold with groanings which cannot be uttered, and produces a mega amount of power in you. Now you are giving God what He needs. You finally have the faith to be set free because you hate it as much as God does.

He puts it to death, and you come out on the other side free.

Then He moves on to the next thing.

Purging the Soul Makes Room for Compassion

He moves on to filthiness of soul: hurts, anger, strife, divisions, unfaithfulness, emotional realms, onslaughts, up and down, back and forth. Most of those things are based on relationships with other people.

This part can take longer.

I remember it taking deep fasting and continued prayer to bring me to the place where I could not hurt anybody on purpose, not in offerings, not through greed, not through anything. It was all about filthiness of soul.

God wants to bring some prophets and other ministries forward.

Matthew 7 says:

Thou hypocrite, first cast out the beam out of thine own eye; and then shalt thou see clearly to cast out the mote out of thy brother's eye.

Jesus called a man in that condition a hypocrite. In the sight of God, hypocrisy is when you are guilty of the same thing you are judging your brother for. You have exalted yourself to a false position of spirituality, and that releases the devil to come.

That is what the next verse means when Jesus says:

Give not that which is holy unto the dogs, neither cast ye your pearls before swine...

The enemy will trample them in the mud and turn and rend you. Your judgment comes back.

If a man has a fault and desperately needs restoring, and you know the walk of the Spirit, then your sincerity to restore him is shown by doing the things necessary to bring your own restoration.

God will walk through hell with a man who has faults and needs restoring, if that man hates his fault as much as God does. All growth is relative to where you came from.

But when you cross the line of hypocrisy and start judging your brother for the same things you are guilty of, you release the devil in your life. That is serious.

When He purges you from filthiness of soul, God can use you tremendously. The same capacity to see people's lives put together, and not to hurt them, is one of the compassion realms that releases God to flow through you powerfully.

Hating the Limitation Opens the Door for Miracles

Finally, filthiness of spirit will be dealt with. Let me tell you what that entails, because this one deals on the ministry level. Your ministry is contained in it.

Suppose they bring fifteen children in wheelchairs up to you: deformed, blind, deaf, mute. They have a covenant because their mother and father have a covenant. They bring them into your ministry. You believe in miracles. God uses you in a certain realm of healing.

At first, when God starts using a person in miracles, he does not like them bringing those cases, because it kills the rest of the crowd's faith when they do not get up.

But by this time you have continued praying in tongues, and you have added the power of fasting. You cannot keep praying in tongues and fasting without God's plan beginning to work out to the nth degree.

God does not want those children in wheelchairs. He is looking for somebody who has brought enough heaven to earth to do something about it.

Just as He purged one man from filthiness of flesh and another from filthiness of soul and began a walk of compassion, now you have prayed yourself to where you hate the thing keeping those children in the wheelchair so badly that your whole life means nothing to you anymore.

You fast so much that all they find is a belly button lying on the rock. You do not care anymore. He brings you into that place of compassion. You look at that mess and hate it so much you cannot stand it. Yet you lay hands on them and nothing happens.

You hate the thing keeping them in those chairs. You hate the limitations imposed on you by the flesh. It drives you back into more fasting and more prayer because you hate the thing that stands between you, God, and those miracles.

Finally, through praying in tongues and fasting, you make it so far into God that you hate it as much as God does. There is nothing between you and heaven anymore. Here He comes. When He does, heaven gets to come here.

That realm is something to behold.

You are not going to empty fifteen wheelchairs because the presence of God has limitations at that point. It has no limitations for that kind of miracle.

What do you think will happen when fifteen children who were born that way, five, six, ten, or twelve years old, are healed? Their parents have known people for twelve to fifteen years. Do you think the devil can afford to have that loosed on your community?

No.

Principalities Resist Prayer Before Revival Reaches the Community

That is why principalities collect powers together and give instructions to rulers of darkness. A ruler of darkness is exactly what it sounds like: a governmental gift of satanic divisions, set by Satan over a dark region to guard against invasions of light.

When Jesus said an unclean spirit goes out of a man and wanders through dry places seeking rest, then takes seven more wicked spirits with him, where did he get the seven? Why is it so organized?

That spirit appealed to a ruler of darkness. These things are not everywhere at once. They report to a ruler of darkness.

They say, "In your section, Mr. Ruler of Darkness, there is a church beginning to pray. People are starting to get set free. Our recommendation is that if you do not release a bunch of devils to stop this now, one day you may be dealing with fifteen wheelchair miracles, and that is going to get into the community. You had better stop it now, or you will have to answer to a power."

The power knows he will have to answer to a principality, and the principality knows one day he will have a conference with Satan and will have lost his region.

So he has to stop you at A so you never see Z.

Some of you do not even know what has happened. This thing is very sophisticated. Jesus said Satan cannot cast Satan out or his kingdom would be divided. His kingdom is highly organized. He is not in a state of confusion.

The low levels are dumb. They are stupid. Usually when you cast them out, they are slobbering, dumb devils. But the more sophisticated devils appear on talk shows. They came out of the closet, did they not? Give them a hand. They finally came out of the closet.

In the unprotected atmosphere of our homes, these devils come on television and begin an indoctrination process for strongholds.

We think the devil is only some slobbering maniac who drags your children into the brush. That is the lowest level there is. The sophisticated ones program society.

When you pray, you tap into the source of illumination, sanctification, and the plan of God. What do you think the devil is going to do, lie down and play dead?

You have emotions that can be played, and if he plays them, you will not be here. You will not stay.

But if you start praying and make it to intercession, no matter what pit you crawled out of, who you hurt, what happened to you, or what you did, stay with the saints. Stay in fellowship with the saints. Be faithful to your vision. For the sake of all the babies coming to the church, be faithful to every public prayer meeting called, if at all possible. The babies are learning from you.

Be as faithful as you can. Let God use you. Do not stop praying.

The Earnest Helps Weakness Until the Course Is Finished

He that has wrought us for the selfsame thing is God. He has wrought us to fulfill the plan of God, receive a glorified body, and go to heaven. God laid the earnest on me so that one day I may become His purchased possession, with the adoption process complete.

Meanwhile, I have Him who helps my weaknesses, and He is everything.

At the conclusion of Romans 8, Paul says:

| If God be for us, who can be against us?

He says:

| Who is he that condemneth?

What kind of power does condemnation have if God is the One who justifies? If Jesus justified me, where does hell get its power to have the final say in my condemnation?

If God is for me, who can be against me?

Paul says:

| I am persuaded, that neither death, nor life, nor angels, nor principalities, nor powers, nor things present, nor things to come... shall be able to separate us from the love of God, which is in Christ Jesus our Lord.

I am thoroughly persuaded that when the Holy Ghost is the earnest and is helping my weaknesses, neither powers, principalities, death, life, things present, nor things to come can separate me from the love of God in Christ Jesus.

I will go to heaven, and I will finish my course.

The Spirit Perfects the Gift and Places It in the Path of Harvest

When you find yourself saying, "God, I do not know what is wrong," and you cannot pray as you ought, you cannot vocalize it, it hurts, and you can hardly say it, you hate where you are but you are not where God wants you to be.

He has reserved for you, when your life comes online enough, mega amounts of intercession for the lost. He has reserved it for your gift to become so perfected that God will place you in the pathway of the lost, and thousands will be born again because they just cannot get past you.

Is it not great that when Benny Hinn was spending eight to twelve hours a day praying in tongues, nobody could get him to stop? Is it not great that God was finally able to sanctify him, pick him up by the nape of the neck, and place him on a path where every time he ministers he stands in the way of thousands and thousands going to hell?

God was able to perfect his gift. He wants to perfect yours.

You are also going to get in the way of the lost, because you will not live on this earth without being part of the Body of Christ, if the Holy Ghost has anything to say about it. The Body is supposed to be a viable, pliable, devil-stomping mechanism that harvests the sinner.

If the Church is not harvesting sinners, then generally we sit around with other believers. We may get full of the Word, but our fellowship will stagnate.

I know some of you are hungry for ministry and the move of the Spirit. That is normal. It is natural in the Spirit to want to be used.

I have often said that when my hunger reaches the point where I am supposed to be ministering myself, I would rather be fixing hot dogs, and then eat the hot dogs I had to fix, than eat filet mignon served by you.

You might be the best teacher in the world and get eighteen people out of wheelchairs. But when it comes time for me to flow in the Spirit, I would rather eat hot dogs I had to fix, because nothing is going to replace what God has ultimately for you in your life and in your ascension to glory.

There is only one way you are going to find it.

For this, He gave you the earnest, God's guarantee. "Here, take My earnest money, because when the end of this purchase is made, you are coming home with Me."

Who is praying for you in tongues?

God the Holy Spirit.